Alexander Elementary School PTA & Title I

Eagle Express

December 2012

From the Principal's Point

Dear Alexander Parents,

We have approached the middle of the second quarter. Students and staff members continue to work toward our academic goals for the year. As parents and guardians, we depend on you to stress the importance of education in your home by checking homework and helping your students prepare for test. Students must demonstrate mastery of grade level standards by the end of the year. If you need assistance or have questions regarding assignments please contact your child's teacher.

Please join us on December 10 at 6:00 for a performance of A Bugz Christmas. Our first and second grade students will present a holiday program that your entire family will enjoy.

School Improvement Council/Title I Planning Committee will meet on December 13 at 12:30 in the room 307. All parents are invited to attend. Our major agenda item is the development of the 2013-2014 Title I plan.

When your child must be out of school, please send an excuse for the absence. Students cannot have more than ten (10) unexcused absences per year. Please make sure students are here by 8:00 every day. When a student is tardy they are missing valuable instructional time.

Make sure that the office has correct phone numbers to contact you in case of an emergency.

Alexander Elementary is successful because of parents, students, staff and community members who work tirelessly to support this school. I appreciate all that you do.

Leda Young,

Principal

Upcoming Events

Greenville Poinsettia Christmas Parade 6:00PM	12/1
Progress Reports	12/3
PTA Holiday Shop	12/10-
PTA/Title I Holiday Program—"A Bugz	12/10
Sic/Title I Meeting—1:00PM	12/13
3rd, 4th & 5th Grade "Jingle Jam" Dance	12/14
Winter Break—No School	12/20-1/1/13

From the Assistant Principal's Desk

The Beta Club is preparing for a fabulous trip to the State Convention. Many thanks for a successful yard sale! We sold a lot of clothing, toys, books, and more. Thank you again for your support!

Sincerely,

Mrs. Stevens

"Jingle Jam 2012" is a dance for 3rd, 4th & 5th grades. Friday, December 14! Proceeds to benefit the Beta Club & the PTA!

From our Parents Teachers Association (PTA)

Greetings Alexander Family,

We are so excited about the month of December. Alexander is bursting with events.

This year's Poinsettia Christmas Parade was a blast! The chorus was outstanding as we marched up a chilly Main Street. Ms. Campbell once again done an outstanding job coordinating everything.

Our PTA/Title I Holiday Program will be Monday, December 10 at 6:00PM. The first and second grades will be performing "A Bugs Christmas"

The "Holiday Shoppe" will start on Monday, December 10 and will end on Friday, December 14. The PTA has chosen KIDsMart to supply the gifts this year. Everything will less than $10.00 this year; so parents can allow their children to purchase gifts for the entire family.

We would like to personally invite each of you to join PTA. It only takes a $5.00 donation. Please help Alexander reach 100% membership.

Have a safe and Happy Holiday season from all of us to all of you.

The PTA Executive Officers.

Tabatha Norwood – PTA President

Tony Norwood – PTA Vice President

Ellen Small – PTA Treasurer

Sabrina Jones – PTA Secretary

Title I Corner

In November we hosted a Read Around the World Night. This turned out to be an exciting adventure. Each student was given a "passport" to travel the world with. We would like to thank all of our teachers and staff that created such exciting and fun filled activities. In addition, we would like to thank the families that can out to support our event. If you missed it do not fear. We will be hosting a Dr. Seuss night in March.

Please continue to join us for our SIC/ Title I Meetings and Coffee with the Principal. We are beginning to plan for our 2013-2014 school year. We will discuss imperative information regarding Title I Planning at these meetings. On December 3rd parent surveys will be sent home. Please take the time to fill these out as they will be used for our Title I Planning. Thanks so much for your support.

Sincerely,

Kara Mann– Title I Facilitator

Craig Blackshire– Parent Coordinator

Henry Whittingham– Parent Coordinator

Alexander Eagle Ensemble

The award winning Eagle Ensemble performed in the Greenville's Poinsettia Christmas Parade on Saturday, December 1. Thank you to those that came and showed your Eagle Pride while supporting our chorus group and the hard work of Ms. Campbell. The parade started at Augusta Street and traveled up Main Street and ends at Elford Street. The Eagle Ensemble won Best Walking/ Marching Unit in last year's parade.

The Ensemble will be performing at the Greenville Memorial Hospital again this year. The performance is on Monday, December 17. Any questions call Ms. Campbell at (864) 355-1031.

First and second graders will be performing in a musical called "A Bugs Christmas". The performance is on Monday, December 10th at 6:00PM following a brief PTA/Title I meeting. Everyone is encouraged to kick off your Holiday Celebrations with the performers.

From Mrs. Gilliland

Parents, thank you for your support for your children this year. Our attendance is good and we hope to continue to improve it even more in the future. Remember that after 10 absences, your child will need a doctor note for every absence. We do have many incentives for perfect attendance, including Papa John pizza coupons, ice cream sundaes at the end of the nine weeks, and student's names entered in a drawing for one bicycle per grade level each nine weeks. Regular school attendance is so important for your child's success in school.

Beverly Gilliland, LMSW
School Social Worker

4K News

On Friday, December 14, Alexander's 4K class is invited to Lakeview Middle School's "Read Around the Christmas Tree Celebration." The middle school students raise the money to hire Greenville County School buses to pick up area 4K classes. Then they divide the children into small groups to listen to stories around the lovely decorated Christmas tree. Finally, we are treated to milk and cookies with Santa. We are looking forward to this special

Kindergarten Corner

The Kindergarten will be visiting The Roper Mountain Science Center to learn about how to keep our body healthy.

Fabulous First Graders

Hi Alexander Family and Friends,

First grade is flying high and soaring. We started some new units this month. We are doing well with them and sailing right through. Reading unit 2 Journeys Sharing Time. Math we started the unit on Develop Subtraction Concepts. Science we are studying the Sun and Moon.

Social Studies we are learning how to locate different things on a Map. We will continue to work hard and do our best through the festive season that is approaching us.

What's Cooking in Second Grade?

Our 2nd graders have had a great time studying animals. We visited the Greenville Zoo where we saw animals in their habitats and learned about different animals' homes. What fun we had learning about animal homes, touching a snake, and observing animals in their environment. James loved looking at the big tortoises. Maylyn enjoyed the baby giraffe and the flamingos in the pond. The highlight of our field trip was getting a peek at the sleeping Kiko, the baby giraffe

Third Grade Rocks!

Minerals for All!

On November 16, third grade had the wonderful opportunity to mine for minerals through Diamond Dell. This was an in-house field trip. Diamond Dell brought a trailer to our back parking lot and opened their doors to us. The students had the opportunity to taking a mining pan, dip it in water and shake it to find the precious gems and minerals. We found one type of rock, pumice, because it floats in water. We also found petrified wood that the students correctly identified as a preserved parts fossil. Other minerals that were found include fluorite, calcite, hematite, and apatite. We discovered many gemstones, which are semi-precious minerals. The list is lengthy, but included quartz, amethyst (our state gemstone), garnet and tiger's eye. Before the long holiday break, we will complete a mineral identification guide and create an egg carton display for our minerals. To accompany our mining experience, we read Magic School Bus Rocky Road Trip. Our trip was not quite as exciting as Ms. Frizzle's class, but we think it "rocked."

4th Grade Scoop

Hail to the Chief…

Fourth grade held a class election in honor of our Nation's Presidential Election.

Our students have been learning about the democratic process and persuasive writing.

The students were required to create a speech and a slogan along with a poster explaining why they would be a good leader. The students dazzled the teachers with their creativity. Each student presented a speech to their respective classes. Once all the speeches were presented our students participated in a class election. The students had to complete a voter registration card and cast their vote for whom they felt represented their beliefs of a good leader.

Congratulations to our fourth grade class presidents: Emma Hopson, Breasia Hunter, and Cassidy Tucker.

5th Grade News

We have begun a new unit, geological landforms, in science. We are identifying and comparing continental and oceanic landforms. We will also classifying natural processes as weathering, erosion, or deposition. One exciting activity the students engaged in was the topographic face map. Students had to study their partner's face, and using face paint, they drew contour lines. Once the contour lines were drawn, students pressed their partner's face against tissue paper to make an impression. This was an enjoyable activity that reinforced map skills.

Alexander Elementary School

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Soar High, Score High

The school nurse is in need of gently used boys pants in sizes 7,8,9,and 10. If yon can help, please bring the clean pants to nurse's office. Thank you.

Coach's Corner

Coach Taylor's PE classes completed a unit on fitness and have started floor hockey skills for the next several lessons.

Fifth grade students are completing their fitness testing which measures four different areas of their fitness.

Remember to be active for 30 to 60 minutes daily and drink plenty of water to achieve good health!

More from the Media Center

So many great things have been going on our school library! Here's just a sample of what we've been up!

Book Fair Update

Thank you! Yes, thanks to your support our November book fair was a marvelous success. Every item sold in the fair benefits our school! The profits raised go toward new books and other special projects and events sponsored by the library.

Take on a Challenge!

Second and third graders are eligible to participate in our first annual Take on a Challenge! reading event. Students read this year's South Carolina Picture Book Award Nominee books then complete a book summary form. For every five books read and summarized, the children receive a prize. It's not too late to Take on a Challenge!

We've Gone to the Dogs

Our third graders enjoyed a visit with Mrs. Keener from the Service Dog Institute. She shared how dogs from the institute are trained to help children live better lives. We enjoyed meeting Sitka, an adult dog, who already lives with a little boy and his family. We all loved meeting Charlotte, an adorable puppy, who is already being trained as a service learning dog. Are you interested in learning more about dogs?

Here are some books that make for some great reading!

Buddy, The First Seeing Eye Dog

Working Dogs

Terra and Bella

Stone Fox

The Bravest Dog Ever: The True Story of Balto